

Cantonese

[jyːtʰjyːʌ]

github.com/cb-g/bhasa

January 10, 2026

1 Phonology

1.1 Vowels

i:	long close front unrounded vowel
y:	long close front rounded vowel
u:	long close back rounded vowel
e	close-mid front unrounded vowel (short, in -eng, -ek only)
ɛ:	long open-mid front unrounded vowel
œ:	long open-mid front rounded vowel
ə	mid central vowel (short, in -eung, -euk only)
o	close-mid back rounded vowel (short, in -ong, -ok only)
ɔ:	long open-mid back rounded vowel
ɐ	short near-open central vowel
a:	long open front unrounded vowel

1.2 Consonants

m	voiced bilabial nasal
n	voiced alveolar nasal
ŋ	voiced velar nasal
p	voiceless bilabial plosive (unaspirated)
p ^h	voiceless bilabial plosive (aspirated)
t	voiceless alveolar plosive (unaspirated)
t ^h	voiceless alveolar plosive (aspirated)
k	voiceless velar plosive (unaspirated)
k ^h	voiceless velar plosive (aspirated)
kw	voiceless labialized velar plosive (unaspirated)
k ^h w	voiceless labialized velar plosive (aspirated)
ts	voiceless alveolar affricate (unaspirated)
ts ^h	voiceless alveolar affricate (aspirated)
f	voiceless labiodental fricative
s	voiceless alveolar fricative
h	voiceless glottal fricative
l	voiced alveolar lateral approximant
w	voiced labio-velar approximant
j	voiced palatal approximant

1.3 Tones

˥	tone 1 (high-level); endonym: ji˥s-˥ŋ˥ or yīshēng
˨˨ or ˨˥	tone 2 (high-rising); endonym: ji˨˨s-˥ŋ˥ or yíshēng
˨	tone 3 (mid-level); endonym: sa:m˥s-˥ŋ˥ or sā:mshēng
˨˥	tone 4 (low-falling); endonym: s˥is-˥ŋ˥ or sēishēng
˨˨ or ˨˥	tone 5 (low-rising); endonym: ŋ˨˨s-˥ŋ˥ or ŋgshēng
˨˥	tone 6 (mid-low-level); endonym: luk˥s-˥ŋ˥ or lùkshēng
˥	tone 7 (high stopped); endonym: f̌sət˥s-˥ŋ˥ or chītshēng
˨˥	tone 8 (mid stopped); endonym: b̌ət˥s-˥ŋ˥ or bātshēng
˨˥	tone 9 (low stopped); endonym: ǧəu˥s-˥ŋ˥ or gǎushēng

2 Glosses

- (1) ŋgoʌ haiʌ tsiːjaʌʌ gœʌ
ngoŋ̌ həǐ jiːyāǔ geŋ̌
1SG be free SFP

I am free.

- (2) neiʌ haiʌ ŋgoʌ gœʌ p^hɛŋʌjaʌʌ
neiŋ̌ həǐ ngoŋ̌ geŋ̌ péngyǎǔ
2SG be 1SG GEN friend

You are my friend.

- (3) ŋgoʌdeiʌ sœŋʌ fɑːnʌ ukʌkeiʌ
ngoŋ̌dèǐ sœúŋ̌ fɑːň ũkkéǐ
1PL want return home

We want to go home.